

Mohsin Chowdhury

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13 September 2026

Our ref: BFE/183331
Parcel 5 of 4

Joe K. Ripple, Floodplain Administrator

Floodplain & 911 Administration
Brazoria County
451 North Velasco, Suite 210
Courthouse West Annex, 2nd floor · Angleton, Texas 77515
Direct (979) 864-1272 · department (979) 864-1295 / (281) 756-1295

Request for a written Base Flood Elevation determination
808 Wagon Wheel Trail — PID 183331 — 1.07 acres of record, Bar-X Ranch #1

Dear Floodplain Administrator,

I am evaluating the vacant parcel identified below for the construction of a single-family residence, and I should be grateful for a written determination of the base flood elevation that applies to it, together with confirmation of the points listed overleaf. I am not yet under contract; the purpose of this request is to establish the regulatory position before committing to a purchase or to a design.

THE PARCEL

Marketed as	808 Wagon Wheel Trail, Angleton, Texas 77515
Situs of record	808 WAGON WHEEL TRAIL
Account / PID	183331 · GEO ID 1533-0131-000
Legal description	BAR X RANCH (A0038 J B BAILEY) LOT 131 ACRES 1.07
Acreage of record	1.07 acres
Subdivision and plat	Bar-X Ranch #1 · plat 16/104 (9 Jun 1980)
Deed reference	2007-000505
Approximate centroid	29.130342, -95.541850

OUR PRESENT UNDERSTANDING, FOR CORRECTION

FEMA zone	Zone AE, special flood hazard area
FIRM panel	48039C0420K, effective 30 December 2020
Nearest published BFE	28.0 ft NAVD88, the line lying about 1,336 ft from the parcel

Natural ground	about 23.6 to 30.1 ft NAVD88 across the parcel, averaging 24.6 ft, from county LiDAR and the USGS 1 m elevation model
Nearest water	Flag Pond, about 21 ft; Flag Lake Levee, about 21 ft
Assumed finished floor	30.0 ft NAVD88, being the published BFE plus 24 inches of freeboard

On that basis the parcel appears to need an engineered pad lifting the building area by approximately 4.7 ft to reach a compliant finished floor. That figure is derived from remote sensing rather than survey, which is one reason I am asking the county to state the governing elevation in writing.

POINTS ON WHICH I REQUEST CONFIRMATION

1. **Written base flood elevation.** The base flood elevation the county applies to this parcel, in feet NAVD88, and the source used to derive it — the Flood Insurance Study profile and cross-section, or the published BFE line, with the method of interpolation if one is used.
2. **Regulatory floodway.** Whether any part of the parcel lies within the regulatory floodway as opposed to the flood fringe.
3. **Minimum finished-floor elevation.** Confirmation of the minimum finished-floor elevation the county will require. Our understanding is the base flood elevation plus 24 inches of freeboard, being a single requirement of 24 inches rather than 24 inches in addition to a further two feet. Please correct that if it is wrong, and state any additional local standard that applies.
4. **Levee status relied upon.** The accreditation status of the Angleton Levee as relied upon in the current mapping, and whether any Letter of Map Revision, physical map revision or preliminary FIRM is pending that would change the zone or the base flood elevation for this parcel.
5. **Fill, no-rise and drainage.** Whether raising a building pad on this parcel requires a no-rise certification, compensatory storage, or a drainage review, and confirmation that a Fill and Grading permit is required in addition to the development permit.
6. **Map amendment on natural grade.** Whether the county considers this parcel a candidate for a Letter of Map Amendment on natural grade, and confirmation that placing fill under the structure would instead require a Letter of Map Revision based on fill.
7. **Permit route and fees.** Confirmation that a single combined Development and Building Permit applies, the fee basis for a single-family residence in a flood zone, and that all contractors must hold county IRC registration before the permit issues.
8. **Elevation certificate.** At what stage an elevation certificate is required, and the form the county accepts.
9. **Jurisdiction.** Confirmation that this parcel is in unincorporated Brazoria County and not within the city limits or extraterritorial jurisdiction of Angleton, so that the county is the permitting authority.
10. **Substantial-damage and repetitive-loss history.** Any record the county holds of flooding, substantial damage or repetitive loss affecting this parcel or its immediate street.

11. **Building envelope on a very narrow parcel.** The parcel measures roughly 490 ft by 110 ft. Against the pad footprint our study assumes, the narrow dimension is about 6 ft short of what a compliant pad with graded side slopes would need. Please confirm the applicable front, side and rear building lines of record, and whether the county will accept retaining structures or certified steeper side slopes to bring a pad within the lot width.
12. **Flag Lake Levee and Flag Pond.** Flag Pond lies about 21 ft from this parcel and the Flag Lake Levee, a structure carried in the National Inventory of Dams, at about the same distance. Please confirm the levee's accreditation status and whether the mapping for this parcel relies on it, its hazard classification and condition rating, whether the parcel lies within a dam-failure inundation area, and any easement or construction restriction attaching to it.
13. **Acreage of record against the county polygon.** The legal description reads 1.07 acres but the county's own parcel polygon computes to about 0.964 acre, a difference of roughly 11 per cent. Please confirm which figure the county treats as controlling for permitting and for any setback calculation.
14. **Recorded drainage easements.** The restrictions of record for this section reference drainage easements at 1712/500. Please confirm whether any mapped drainage easement crosses this parcel.

If any of the figures above is wrong, I would be glad to be corrected — establishing the right numbers now is the object of the exercise. If a fee or a formal application is required for a written determination, please tell me the amount and the form to use and I will submit it promptly.

I am writing from out of state, so a reply by e-mail to **mms221@gmail.com** would be most helpful, and I am reachable on (702) 582-5724 during Pacific business hours. I am glad to telephone the office if that is easier than writing.

Thank you for your assistance.

Yours faithfully,

Mohsin Chowdhury

This is one of five parcels I am evaluating in Bar X Ranch. A combined request covering all five is available if the office would prefer to answer them together.

Parcel figures are drawn from the Brazoria County Appraisal District record, the county public GIS services and the USGS 3DEP elevation model, as compiled in the four-lot feasibility portfolio v4.0. They are stated for correction, not as assertions of fact.